(with the sacred history of which you are better acquainted than I am) and all at once we determined to proceed thither. We applied to the Aga for a man as guide and guard which he very kindly gave us and started the next morning two hours before daylight being altogether 5 in company.

After a long and painful days march at first through low marshy ground and after over high and picturesque mountains we arrived at a miserable Turkish village 2 hours distant from Ephesus. There we took up our boots for the night — the only place we could get was a compartment of a stable the roof of which was in such a state that we had the gratification of counting the stars as we lay down and the door half off added to which half a dozen camel drivers were our companions. Poor Fowler was dreadfully deranged by all this. However after getting over the night we set out for the ruins which to my companions completely made up for their suffering during the night, as to myself I was not so much in extatics and in passing a fine Basso Relievo over an archway I fired a ball to bring down a piece of the knee to carry away. I knocked off a piece but the Antiquarians were so dreadfully outraged that I was obliged to give them the precious piece of marble as a peace offering.

At Ephesus we could find nothing to eat either for ourselves or our horses, but they told us that if we went to Lelan Miova 4 hours distant over the mountains we should get everything we wanted. Thither we went and found the Turks in the greatest ferment at our approach, the Consulate was closed and the Consul had been gone ever since the news of the battle of Navarin[4] and there was not a Frank in the place. With much trouble we persuaded a Jew Dragueman to let us into the empty Consulate and sent a man to the Aga to say we were Americans who wished to stay there that night. He answered we might remain in the Consulate that night but he advised us to depart by daylight in the morning, and to take a different route as he could not answer for the intentions of his people with regard to us. We thanked him and started in the morning at 4 o'clock and after a ride over the mountains of about 16 hours arrived at Lidigin, where we stopped the night and proceeded the next day to Smirna and were told by the people there we might think ourselves very lucky to have come off so well during a time when we had neither Ambassador nor a Consul in the Turkish dominions.

I had written this much intending to have sent my letter from Smirna but having decided to sail on the 12th on board a Dutch ship I determined to send it from Constantinople. I will merely now inform you that I arrived here [Constantinople] safe on March 25th after a delightful passage, that I have found here a Dr. Schultz, a professor in the employ of the French government who has

[4] The more or less accidental encounter between an Allied squadron and the Turkish fleet in the harbor of Navarino accomplished the total destruction of the latter, and dealt Turkish naval forces a blow from which the "Sick Man" never recovered.

Generated on 2020-09-15 23:12 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112401
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN